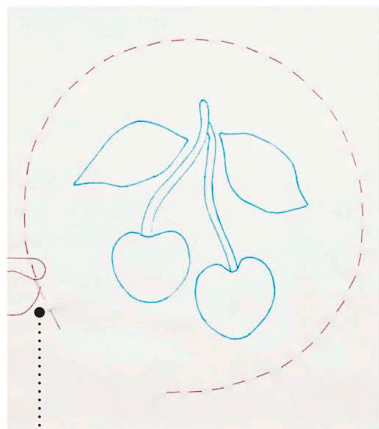


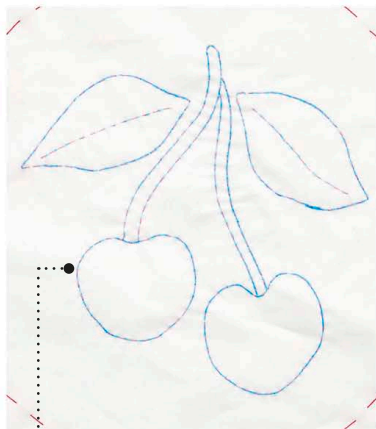
► CORDED QUILTING AND TRAPUNTO

Corded quilting, or Italian quilting, and trapunto, or stuffed quilting, are techniques that can be used separately, but they work well together. Both involve stitching a design through a top and a thin backing layer,

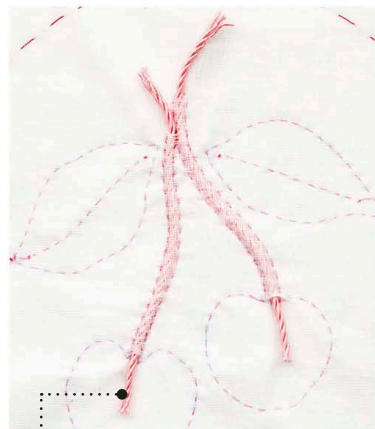
usually of butter muslin. The motif is then filled from the back with lengths of quilting, knitting wool or soft cord, or with stuffing material. The outline is traditionally worked by hand.



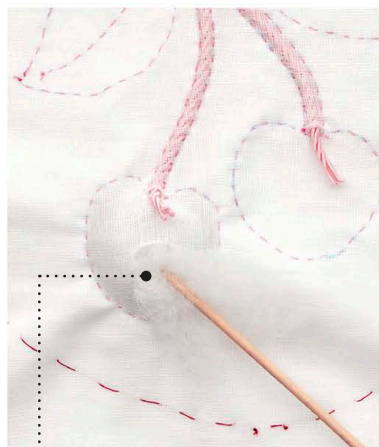
1 Cut a background fabric and transfer the design to the right side, using a water-soluble pen. Cut a piece of butter muslin or similar fabric the same size. Tack them together around the edges.



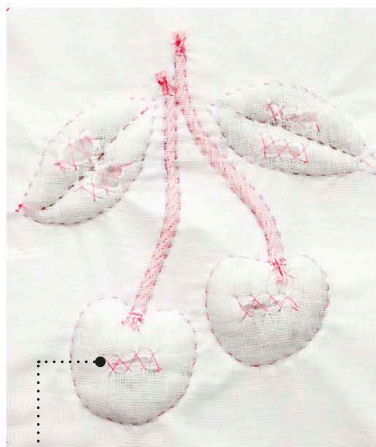
2 Outline the motif(s) with a small running stitch. Here we have used a contrasting colour thread for clarity. Where lines meet, keep stitches separate so they don't cross over. When stitching is complete, remove the marking.



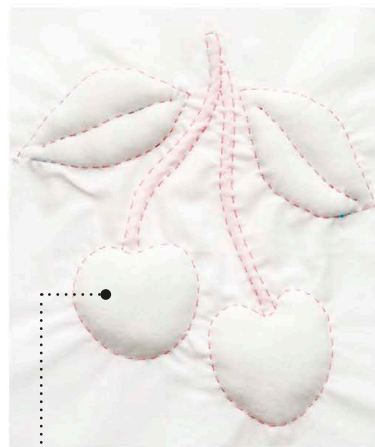
3 Thread a tapestry needle with quilting or knitting wool or soft cord. From the back, slip the needle through the first channel, leaving a short tail at each end.



4 Make small slits in the centre of each element through the backing layer only and stuff small pieces of wadding between the top and the muslin.



5 Close each slit in the backing with a crossed stitch, such as herringbone. Remove the tacking stitches once the design is complete.



6 The cording and trapunto gives the finished motif a three-dimensional quality on the right side.